

KWAKU KARIKARI MANU, PMP

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<https://mkwakukarikari.github.io/index.html>

EDUCATION

PhD Candidate in Geography (Urban and Regional Planning Specialization) Expected May 2027
The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL

Master of Science, Geography (Urban and Regional Planning Specialization) Aug 2025
The University of Alabama, Tuscaloosa, AL

Master of Project Management Dec 2022
Ghana Institute of Management and Public Administration, Accra, Ghana

PG Diploma in Sustainable Urban Development (Infrastructure and Green Cities) Mar 2022
Erasmus University, Rotterdam, Netherlands

Bachelor of Science, Urban and Regional Planning Hons. Jul 2020
Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology, Kumasi, Ghana

RELEVANT SKILLS

ArcGIS Pro	ArcMap	ArcGIS Online	QGIS	Adobe Creative Suite
R Programming	Python Programming	SPSS	Drone Operation	Microsoft Suite

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Transportation Planning Intern Sep 2025 – Jan 2026
Toole Design Group, Atlanta, GA

- Conducted community engagement initiatives to promote multimodal transportation and active mobility adoption.
- Provided one-on-one route planning and guided practice trips to support behavioral shifts toward sustainable transportation.
- Supported public outreach through workshops, community events, and transportation education programs.
- Delivered MyGCO training and demonstrations to promote sustainable transportation behavior.

Research Assistant Apr 2025 – Aug 2025
Alabama Transportation Institute, University of Alabama

- Conducted research on active mobility, transportation safety, and sustainable transportation systems in the US & Ghana.
- Analyzed transportation and infrastructure data using GIS, Python, and R for statistical modeling and spatial analysis.
- Contributed to peer-reviewed publications, conference papers, and technical reports.
- Collaborated with interdisciplinary teams to develop data-driven, policy-relevant transportation recommendations.

Transportation Planner Nov 2021 – Aug 2023
Department of Urban Roads, MRT, Accra, Ghana

- Supported the development of long-range transportation strategies through corridor analysis, traffic data evaluation, GIS mapping, and infrastructure needs assessments.
- Integrated pedestrian, bicycle, and multimodal transportation considerations into roadway planning initiatives to improve accessibility and connectivity.

- Participated in stakeholder consultations and public engagement activities to incorporate community perspectives into transportation planning decisions.
- Evaluated traffic routing strategies and network performance to improve urban mobility, accessibility, and transportation system efficiency.
- Developed GIS maps, spatial analyses, and technical documentation to support transportation planning studies, grant applications, and infrastructure funding proposals.

Transportation Planner

Apr 2020 – Dec 2020

ROM Transportation Engineering Limited, Ghana

- Supported the feasibility study for a Bus Rapid Transit (BRT) system in Kumasi.
- Conducted traffic counts and mobility data collection across key urban corridors.
- Produced transport network maps and route analyses to support planning decisions.

Transportation Planning Intern

May 2019 – Aug 2019

Kumasi Metro Transportation Department

- Drafted and assisted with the implementation of traffic management strategies to reduce congestion in Kumasi.
- Assisted with improving pedestrian and non-motorized transport facilities to enhance walkability and safety.
- Led team training on data collection tools and stakeholder engagement techniques.
- Supported grant applications securing (Bloomberg Initiative, AFD) through GIS mapping and technical analysis.

Transportation Planning Intern

May 2018 – Aug 2018

Municipal Planning Office, Ghana

- Analyzed transportation data and produced GIS maps to support planning decisions.
- Conducted traffic counts and field data collection for transportation analysis.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant

Aug 2025 – Present

Department of Geography and the Environment, University of Alabama

- Conduct spatial and statistical analysis using ArcGIS Pro and R to examine health disparities and spatial accessibility.
- Support research projects through data analysis, literature synthesis, and preparation of publication-ready figures and manuscripts.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Aug 2023 – Mar 2025

Department of Geography and the Environment, University of Alabama

- Assisted instruction for 90+ undergraduate students in physical geography courses.
- Assisted with grading, course coordination, and student engagement.

Teaching and Research Assistant

Sep 2020 – Sep 2021

Department of Planning, Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology

- Supported teaching and research in urban and rural planning.
- Contributed to transportation research and supervised undergraduate student projects.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Appiah-Opoku, S., Manu, K. K., & Sampson, L. E. (2025). *Assessing motorcycle taxis as transport option in African cities: The case of Accra. Journal of African Studies and Development.*
- Manu, K. K., Appiah-Opoku, S., Weber, J., et al. (2025). *Diabetes prevalence and healthcare accessibility in Alabama's Black Belt region. Journal of Diabetes and Endocrinology.*